

THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE GRID EQUIPMENT THESIS

The Backlog Sold Too Cheap

On 5 August, Siemens Energy reported the best quarter in its history. Orders of €17.9bn were a record. The order backlog reached €162bn, an all-time high, against quarterly revenue of €11.4bn — a book-to-bill ratio of 1.57. Profit before special items more than tripled, to €1,623m from €497m a year earlier. The shares fell.

Two weeks before, GE Vernova had done something similar: orders up 88 per cent organically, a \$176bn backlog, free cash flow guidance raised from \$6.5–7.5bn to \$11.5–12.5bn. Those shares fell too. The question in grid equipment is no longer whether the demand is real. It is what a record order is actually worth.

A reframe worth holding onto

A backlog is not a stock of future profit. It is a schedule of obligations, each one priced at the moment it was signed and delivered years later at costs nobody could see at signature.

Read book-to-bill less as a growth signal and more as a duration signal: it measures how many years of revenue have been locked at old prices. In a period of falling input costs that is an asset. In a period of rising ones it is something closer to a fixed-rate loan the manufacturer has written to its customer.

Method. All figures here are external and dated: company results from the companies' own releases and presentations, lead times and equipment prices from trade reporting, interconnection data from Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory, demand forecasts from the US Energy Information Administration, copper from exchange data as at 5 August 2026. The firm's internal research Wiki could not be reached during this automated run, so this edition carries no internal view and attributes no claim to any research provider. Where an argument would ordinarily rest on the Wiki it rests on management's own statements instead — labelled as such, and treated as interested testimony rather than verified fact.

Consider a restaurant that sells gift vouchers. Fifty pounds buys a voucher redeemable against any meal, any time. They sell briskly — so briskly that the outstanding voucher book reaches a record, and the owner begins to describe it as the best indicator of the business's health. Somebody has handed over cash, and every voucher is a customer who will walk through the door. But the vouchers will be redeemed against next year's menu, at next year's price for beef, and the kitchen has already raised the same plate to £70. Every old voucher redeemed is a meal served at a twenty-pound discount agreed before anyone knew what beef would cost. The book is at once the evidence of demand and the bill for having met it early: its size says how much demand exists, its vintage says what that demand will earn. Grid equipment is that restaurant, with delivery measured in years rather than months, and copper instead of beef.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

€162bn

Siemens Energy's order backlog at the end of its fiscal third quarter, an all-time high, on a book-to-bill of 1.57. Profit before special items of €1,623m against €497m.

Siemens Energy Q3 FY2026 earnings release, 5 August 2026.

128 weeks

Average lead time for a power transformer, or roughly two and a half years. Generator step-up units ran to 144 weeks, switchgear to 44.

POWER magazine, January 2026, citing Q2 2025 market data.

13%

Share of US interconnection requests filed between 2000 and 2020 that had reached commercial operation by end-2025. Three-quarters were withdrawn.

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory, Queued Up: 2026 Edition, May 2026.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

Two record quarters, two falling share prices

Siemens Energy's fiscal third quarter, reported on 5 August 2026, was strong in every division. Gas Services took €10.0bn of orders, up 62 per cent, on a book-to-bill of 2.7, lifting its backlog to €73bn from €53bn at a 17.3 per cent margin against 13.0 per cent. Grid Technologies took €5.4bn of orders, up 28 per cent, grew revenue 29 per cent and delivered a 19.9 per cent margin against 15.9 per cent. Siemens Gamesa, the wind business that has absorbed the group's attention for four years, recorded its first quarterly operating profit since fiscal 2022 — a 2.7 per cent margin against minus 17.5 per cent, with the nine-month loss cut to €15m from €1,061m. Free cash flow before tax was €2,319m against €419m.

The market response was a decline of roughly 0.9 per cent. On the call, management pointed to a moderately softer fourth quarter on seasonality and noted that some third-quarter strength reflected timing effects that would not repeat — a thin reason to sell a quarter of this quality, which suggests the selling was about something else. It was not the first time. In June, after an equally strong second quarter of €17.7bn of orders, up 29.5 per cent, with guidance raised the previous month, the shares had fallen 19 per cent over thirty days to €144.60.

GE Vernova's second quarter, reported on 22 July 2026, told the same story in dollars. Orders of \$24.2bn were up 88 per cent organically; revenue of \$11.1bn rose 22 per cent; the backlog stood at \$176bn after growing \$13.0bn in the quarter; free cash flow of \$5.1bn in three months exceeded the whole of 2025. Power orders rose 135 per cent to \$16.7bn and Electrification 66 per cent to \$6.3bn, at margins of 18.8 and 18.4 per cent. Data-centre orders passed \$5bn year to date, more than double the 2025 total. The shares fell about 6 per cent.

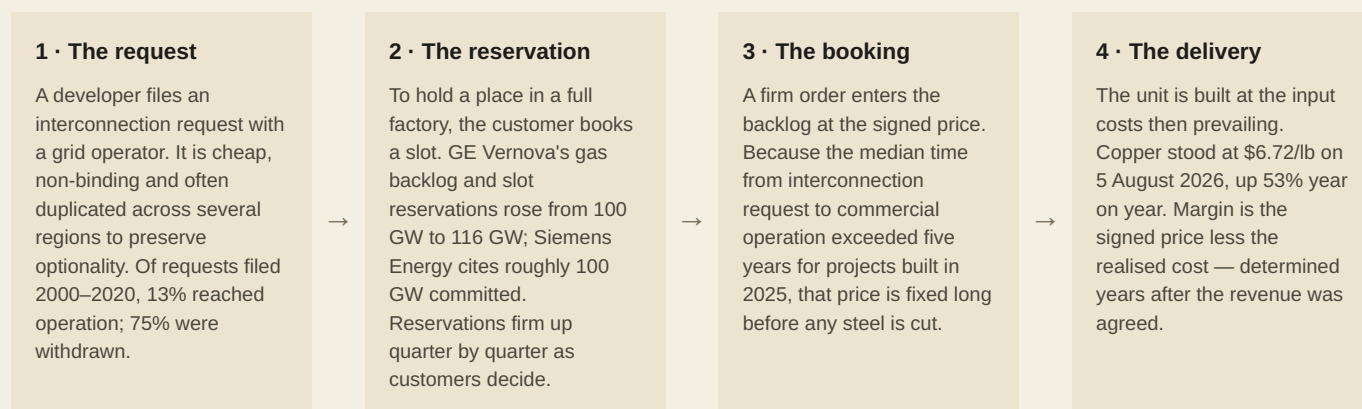
What the market fixed on was the one segment going backwards. Wind orders fell 39 per cent, revenue 10 per cent, and the segment lost money at a minus 13.6 per cent EBITDA margin, 630 basis points worse, with about \$400m of losses guided for the year on higher offshore project costs. That is a real problem and a small one: against guided 2026 revenue of \$45.5–46.5bn, Wind's loss is roughly one per cent of the top line. A 6 per cent fall on a segment that size, in a quarter that added \$5bn of cash, is not a considered verdict on wind turbines. It is what happens when a market has stopped believing that orders and profits are the same thing, and goes looking for a reason to say so.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

An order is a promise to deliver at a price. A backlog is a stack of those promises, each frozen at the moment it was signed. Revenue growth tells you how fast the stack is being worked through. It says nothing about what the stack is worth. *Those are two different questions, and only one of them has been answered.*

How a gigawatt of demand becomes a margin

The chain from a data centre's ambition to an equipment maker's profit has four links. The price is set at the second; the cost is set at the fourth. That gap is the whole subject.



Sources: Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory, *Queued Up: 2026 Edition* (May 2026), for request-to-operation completion rates and median duration; GE Vernova Q2 2026 earnings release (22 July 2026) for gas backlog and slot reservations; Siemens Energy Q3 FY2026 results call (5 August 2026) for committed gas turbine volume; exchange copper price as at 5 August 2026. Step descriptions are the editor's synthesis of these sources, not a company disclosure.

Two consequences follow, in opposite directions. A rising backlog in a rising-cost environment mechanically dilutes near-term margin, because every quarter's revenue is drawn disproportionately from bookings made when prices were lower — which is why margin expansion in long-cycle capital goods arrives late, gradually, and long after the order announcements that supposedly signalled it. But the same mechanism runs in reverse once the old book is consumed. Siemens Energy's management said on 5 August that orders booked today carry higher margins than the existing backlog, and that backlog project margins had improved year to date across almost all business areas. If that holds, reported margin should keep rising for years as a matter of arithmetic, with no further improvement in pricing at all.

That is the bull case in its most defensible form, and it is not a claim that demand will accelerate. It is a claim that a mix shift already contracted for will show up in the accounts. The risk is not that the argument is wrong but that it is slow, well understood, and vulnerable at one point: if today's high-margin orders rest on load that never arrives, the good vintage never reaches the kitchen.

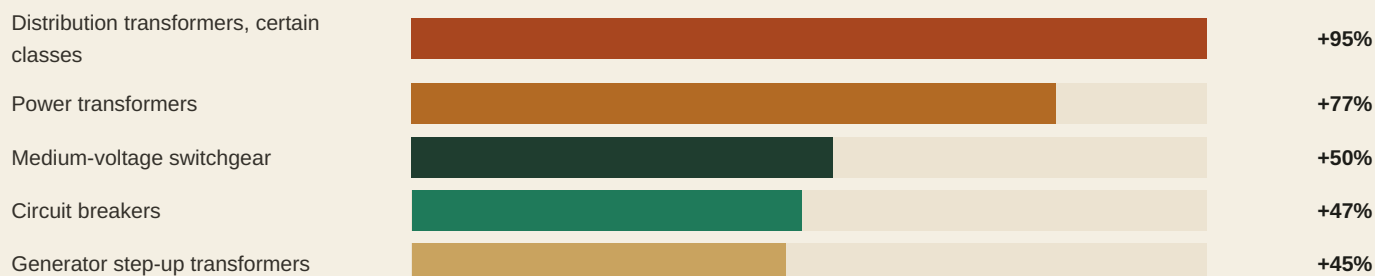


All three figures as reported by the sources named. The juxtaposition is the editor's; no company has presented these numbers together or drawn this inference.

THE CENTRAL COMPARISON

What the equipment costs now against what it cost then

A vintage argument matters here more than in most industries because of the size of the repricing. These are not percentage-point adjustments but step changes in the value of a manufacturing slot, and they happened while multi-year order books were being signed.



Price increases as reported by POWER magazine, January 2026. Transformer, GSU and distribution figures are measured from 2019; switchgear and circuit breakers from 2021, so the bars are not strictly comparable. Bar lengths are illustrative and scaled to the largest value; they are a visual aid, not a measurement. Over the same period the same source reports demand growth of 119% for power transformers, 274% for generator step-up units and 34% for distribution transformers, against projected 2025 supply shortfalls of 30% and 10% for power and distribution transformers respectively.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Treat the order book as a fixed-rate mortgage written by the customer. The manufacturer has locked its revenue for years; the customer has locked its cost. Whoever misjudged the direction of input prices at signature pays for the error at delivery — *and the bill arrives one project at a time, years later, in a line item called margin.*

THE SHIFT

What has actually changed

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Electricity demand stopped being flat	US consumption of 4,195bn kWh in 2025, forecast at 4,269bn kWh in 2026 and 4,399bn kWh in 2027, after nearly two decades of little change. Commercial demand, which includes data centres, has grown at an average 2.6% a year since 2020.	The aggregate load is real, but its location and timing are not. A grid operator cannot build a substation for demand that may appear in a different state.
Pricing power moved to the seller	Gas Services margin of 17.3% from 13.0%; Grid Technologies 19.9% from 15.9%. Management reports no sign of pricing deterioration in gas turbines.	By the company's own account pricing is "plateauing" at high levels. Meanwhile roughly \$1.8bn of North American transformer capacity has been announced, much of it starting up in 2027.
Cash arrived before profit	GE Vernova generated \$5.1bn of free cash flow in a single quarter and raised full-year guidance to \$11.5–12.5bn from \$6.5–7.5bn. Siemens Energy's pre-tax free cash flow was €2,319m against €419m.	Much of it is customer advances on equipment not yet built. Cash received against an undelivered obligation is a liability first and a profit later, and it reverses if orders are cancelled.
The bottleneck moved from generation to connection	1,312 GW of generation and 749 GW of storage sit in US interconnection queues across roughly 8,200 projects. The US built 888 miles of high-capacity transmission in	A connection bottleneck guarantees equipment demand and simultaneously guarantees that projects slip, which delays the conversion of backlog into revenue.

2024 against a Department of Energy estimate of 5,000 miles needed annually.

The politics turned

PJM's forward capacity auction cost rose from \$2.2bn for the 2024–25 delivery year to \$16.4bn for 2027–28. Retail electricity prices rose 8.25% year on year nationally, and 19.35% in Virginia.

Rising bills force grid investment and invite the cost-allocation rules that slow it. Ohio now requires data centres to fund at least 85% of projected use; Virginia has imposed 14-year contracts.

THE TWO CASES

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **The margin improvement is contracted, not forecast.**

Management stated on 5 August 2026 that orders booked today carry higher margins than the existing backlog, and that backlog project margins improved year to date across almost all business areas. If accurate, reported margin rises on mix arithmetic without any further price increase.

- **The physical shortage is measured, not asserted.** Power transformer lead times of 128 weeks and generator step-up times of 144 weeks are the observable form of a deficit a two-year factory build cannot close quickly.

- **Guidance is being raised on cash, not hope.** GE Vernova nearly doubled full-year free cash flow guidance mid-year, to \$11.5–12.5bn. Siemens Energy guides to about €8bn pre-tax free cash flow and €4bn net income.

- **The demand is broader than artificial intelligence.** Siemens Energy cited both US data centres and Middle Eastern grid modernisation. Separately, over half of roughly 40 million US distribution transformers are past their expected service life.

- **The loss-making division is closing.** Siemens Gamesa's nine-month loss fell to €15m from €1,061m. If the wind drag disappears, group earnings converge on the quality already visible in gas and grid.

The bear case

- **The demand signal is inflated and the utilities say so.** Exelon expects only about 22% of a 65 GW data-centre pipeline through 2040 to materialise. Camus Energy has estimated five to ten times more interconnection requests than data centres built.

- **Historical conversion is dismal.** Of interconnection requests filed 2000–2020, 13% reached operation and 75% were withdrawn. A backlog is only worth its cancellation rate, and these counterparties have a documented habit of walking away.

- **Capacity is being added against the shortage.** Roughly \$1.8bn of announced North American transformer investment — Hitachi Energy over \$1bn, Eaton \$340m, Prolec GE over \$300m, Siemens Energy \$150m — largely lands from 2027. Scarcity multiples do not survive supply.

- **Management already concedes the peak in pricing.** Pricing was described as intact but "plateauing" on the 5 August call, with forgings and castings constraints improving. Both are the language of a cycle maturing rather than tightening.

- **The bill has become political.** Retail power is up 8.25% nationally and 19.35% in Virginia, with PJM capacity costs up more than sevenfold. Ohio's 85% funding rule, Virginia's 14-year contracts and FERC's direction to PJM on co-located load all raise the cost of speculative capacity — prudent policy, a smaller order book, and delay, which is the one risk equipment makers cannot hedge.

The bear case above was built almost entirely from external reporting and from tensions inside the companies' own disclosures, because no internal research view was available to this run. Two of its strongest points — that pricing is plateauing and that supply-chain constraints are easing — come from management's own remarks on the 5 August call, offered as reassurance. That is the most useful kind of bear evidence: not a sceptic's inference, but the seller's own description of conditions, read for what it implies rather than what it intends.

WHERE THE VIEWS COLLIDE

An unresolved conflict

The conflict this edition cannot settle sits between two sets of people who both have direct knowledge and opposite incentives. The equipment makers, reporting through 22 July and 5 August 2026, describe a structural boom: record orders, improving backlog margins, no pricing deterioration, roughly 100 to 116 GW of committed gas turbine volume. The utilities that must actually connect the load describe something quite different: Exelon probability-weighting a 65

GW pipeline down to 22 per cent, operators receiving five to ten times more requests than get built, and a national body of evidence in which three-quarters of historical interconnection requests were abandoned. Both accounts are first-hand. They cannot both be fully true, because the equipment makers' order book is downstream of exactly the demand the utilities are discounting.

Reconciliations are available — that the equipment book is drawn from the most creditworthy and advanced slice of the pipeline, or that duplicate requests still resolve into one real project each. Both are plausible; neither is verified. What can be said is that a firm order backed by a deposit is a stronger claim than an interconnection request, and that no external source consulted for this edition quantifies the cancellation rate on the equipment backlog specifically. That is the number that would settle the argument, and it is not disclosed. The conflict is recorded and left open.

THE DASHBOARD

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
Book-to-bill falling towards 1.0	Orders arriving no faster than deliveries. Siemens Energy's group ratio was 1.57 in Q3 FY2026, with Gas Services at 2.7.	Book-to-bill is the cleanest read on whether the seller still sets the price. It turns before margin does.
Gas backlog and slot reservations against the 125 GW target	GE Vernova moved from 100 GW to 116 GW and has guided to at least 125 GW by the end of 2026. Reservations can fall as well as rise.	Slot reservations are the least binding part of the book. A stall there is the earliest visible sign that speculative load is being withdrawn.
Transformer lead times shortening	Any sustained move down from 128 weeks for power transformers, particularly as 2027 capacity starts up.	Lead time is the shortage made legible. It is the variable that most directly supports current pricing, and the first to give way as supply lands.
Copper and grain-oriented electrical steel	Copper at \$6.72/lb on 5 August 2026, up 53% year on year.	Input costs are realised at delivery against prices fixed at booking. Continued strength compresses the margin on the older vintage of the backlog.
PJM's tariff revisions on co-located load	FERC has directed the largest US grid operator to write clear rules for large and co-located loads.	The rules decide who funds interconnection. Stricter terms filter speculative projects out of the queue, shrinking the order pipeline while improving its quality.
Retail electricity prices and state cost-allocation rules	Prices up 8.25% nationally year on year, 19.35% in Virginia; PJM capacity costs from \$2.2bn to \$16.4bn between the 2024–25 and 2027–28 delivery years.	Political tolerance is the ultimate constraint on the build-out. Consumer backlash arrives as delay, and delay is the risk the equipment makers cannot price.

Three postures, not one answer

Own the bottleneck

The grid and transformer businesses where lead times are longest and substitution hardest. The cost: the most crowded reading of the theme, paying a scarcity multiple for a scarcity that roughly \$1.8bn of announced North American capacity is being built to remove from 2027.

Own the conversion

The companies whose older, cheaper backlog is closest to being worked through, where reported margin should rise on mix alone. The cost: the argument is arithmetic rather than eventful, takes years, and depends on management's unaudited characterisation of backlog margins being accurate.

Own the input

Copper, electrical steel and cable, where price resets immediately rather than at contracted rates. The cost: no order book to cushion a downturn, and so no protection at all if the build-out slips by two years rather than arriving on schedule.

The companies named below are illustrative of how the theme appears in listed equities. They are NOT recommendations, and no view is expressed on the merits of any security. Figures are external and dated; readers should verify current data before drawing conclusions.

ENR

Siemens Energy AG · Xetra

€162bn backlog
5 Aug 2026

The clearest single instrument for the vintage argument, because management has described the mechanism explicitly. Q3 FY2026 delivered record orders of €17.9bn, profit before special items of €1,623m against €497m, and a Grid Technologies margin of 19.9%. FY2026 guidance implies 25–27% revenue growth and an 18–20% margin at Grid Technologies. Siemens Gamesa's return to a small quarterly profit removes the drag that has dominated the equity story since 2022. The shares nonetheless fell on the print, as they did in June after an equally strong quarter.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the guided softer fourth quarter is seasonal, as management says, or the first sign that Q3's order strength was a timing effect.

GEV

GE Vernova Inc · NYSE

\$176bn backlog
22 Jul 2026

The largest expression of the gas-plus-grid combination and the clearest case of a market refusing to pay for orders. Q2 2026 orders rose 88% organically to \$24.2bn, Power orders 135% and Electrification 66%, with segment margins of 18.8% and 18.4%. Free cash flow of \$5.1bn in the quarter exceeded all of 2025 and full-year guidance was raised to \$11.5–12.5bn. Data-centre orders passed \$5bn year to date. The shares fell about 6% on a Wind segment representing roughly one per cent of guided revenue.

WATCH NEXT

The path from 116 GW to the guided 125 GW of gas backlog and slot reservations by year-end, and whether offshore wind costs stabilise.

ETN

Eaton Corporation plc · NYSE

Electrical backlog +43%
30 Jul 2026

The North American electrical distribution layer, closest to the data centre itself. Q2 2026 revenue of \$8.5bn rose 21%, 14% organically, at a 23.1% segment margin, with adjusted earnings of \$3.15 a share. Electrical Americas orders rose 41% and Electrical Global 33% on a twelve-month rolling basis; electrical backlog rose 43% year on year on a book-to-bill of 1.2. Guidance was raised to 11–13% organic growth and adjusted earnings of \$13.40–13.60. The group is also separating its Mobility business by Reverse Morris Trust, expected to close in Q1 2027.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the \$340m South Carolina transformer plant, targeted for 2027, arrives as capacity relief or as an admission that pricing has peaked.

SU

Schneider Electric SE · Euronext Paris

H1 margin 19.3%
H1 2026

The most direct read on data-centre electrical demand rather than on grid infrastructure. Q2 2026 revenue of €11.46bn grew 16.5% organically; first-half revenue of €21.23bn grew 14% with adjusted EBITA of €4.09bn at a 19.3% margin. The company reported triple-digit growth in the pure data-centre segment across hyperscale, colocation, sovereign and regional operators, with the systems business up 28% organically and accounting for 35% of second-quarter revenue. Full-year targets were upgraded on a record backlog.

WATCH NEXT

Whether triple-digit data-centre growth persists as utilities impose take-or-pay terms that filter speculative projects out of the pipeline.

PRY

Prysmian SpA · Borsa Italiana

€17bn transmission book
H1 2026

Cable is the input-cost expression of the theme, and the one with the least protection from a fixed order book. First-half 2026 revenue of €11,239m grew 7.2% organically; adjusted EBITDA of €1,331m lifted the margin to 14.8% from 13.8%, and net profit reached a first-half record of €569m. Transmission revenue of €882m in Q2 grew 14.3% organically at a 21.2% margin, against 17.1%, on a €17bn backlog. Guidance was raised to €2,800–2,900m of adjusted EBITDA and €1,650–1,750m of free cash flow.

WATCH NEXT

How much of the copper move passes through rather than being absorbed, and whether the €10bn of announced transformative deals converts on schedule.

6501

Hitachi Ltd · Tokyo · Hitachi Energy

>\$1bn N. America capex
announced Jun 2024

Hitachi Energy is among the largest suppliers of high-voltage transformers and direct-current transmission equipment, and is spending most visibly against the shortage. It committed an additional \$4.5bn of investment through 2027, announced in June 2024, of which over \$1bn is directed at North American transformer capacity including South Boston and the Alamo expansion. The exposure is held through the listed parent, so grid economics arrive diluted by an unrelated conglomerate.

WATCH NEXT

Commissioning dates on the North American plants. They are the clearest calendar for when the transformer shortage begins to ease.

The bottom line

What was repriced over the past fortnight was not the demand for grid equipment. That was confirmed twice, at scale, with cash. What was repriced was the value of an order. A market that spent two years paying for announcements has begun asking what vintage the backlog is, what it was priced at, and how much of it rests on load that will actually be built. On the evidence available the arithmetic of mix favours the sellers: their newest bookings genuinely carry better margins than the book they are working through, so reported numbers should improve for several years without further help from pricing.

The evidence is also mixed in a way that should not be smoothed over. The same managements that describe a structural boom also describe pricing as plateauing and supply constraints as easing, and roughly \$1.8bn of announced capacity is being built specifically to end the shortage from 2027. Meanwhile the utilities closest to the load are probability-weighting their own pipelines down to about a fifth, in an industry where three-quarters of historical interconnection requests were abandoned. The reasonable inference is that the profit cycle has further to run than the share prices imply while the order cycle is closer to its peak than the order numbers imply — not contradictory, merely uncomfortable together. The next test is narrow and dated: whether GE Vernova reaches its guided 125 GW of gas backlog and slot reservations by the end of 2026, and whether Siemens Energy's softer fourth quarter proves seasonal or structural.

Editorial note. This is educational commentary prepared for internal use at Heyokha Brothers. It is not investment advice, not a recommendation, and not an offer or solicitation in respect of any security. Companies named are illustrative of how a theme appears in listed markets; no view is expressed on the merits of any security, and holdings may or may not exist. All external figures carry an as-of date and were verified against the sources listed below at the time of writing; markets move and figures go stale. Internal Wiki material, where used, represents the opinions of named third-party research providers, labelled as views rather than forecasts, and is never presented as verified fact — none was available for this edition, as disclosed below. Where internal and external accounts conflict, the conflict is stated rather than resolved.

Sources and update notes

(a) Internal sources. None. The Heyokha research Wiki MCP server was not reachable during this automated run, and no wiki tools were exposed to the session at any point. No theme page, source-summary page, entity-scoring pass or relation lookup could be performed, so this edition cites no Wiki page, no created or last-reviewed date, and no research provider issue. Nothing in this edition should be read as reflecting the firm's internal research view on grid equipment, because that view was not available to be read. The topic was selected by external hot-signal reasoning instead, as described in paragraph (d).

(b) Limitation on the internal view. The standing limitation in this format is provider concentration: a Wiki theme page leans on a small number of research houses and inherits their priors. This edition has the opposite and more severe limitation — no internal view at all, and therefore no independent check on the companies' own account of their business. That matters here specifically. The central bull mechanism, that newer bookings carry higher margins than the existing backlog, rests on management's characterisation of its own unaudited backlog margins, made on a results call, with no external party able to verify it. A provider view would normally sit alongside that claim as a second opinion. Readers should discount the bull case accordingly, and treat the bear case — built from third-party data and from tensions inside the companies' own disclosures — as the better-evidenced of the two on this occasion.

(c) External sources. 1. Siemens Energy, Earnings Release Q3 FY2026, 5 August 2026: orders €17.9bn; revenue €11.4bn (+18.5% comparable); backlog €162bn; book-to-bill 1.57; profit before special items €1,623m against €497m; net income €1,188m against €697m; pre-tax free cash flow €2,319m against €419m; FY2026 guidance of 14–16% comparable growth, about €4bn net income and about €8bn pre-tax free cash flow, with 25–27% growth and an 18–20% margin guided at Grid Technologies. **2. Siemens Energy Q3 FY2026 presentation and results call, 5 August 2026, as reported by Investing.com:** Gas Services orders €10.0bn (+62%), revenue €3.8bn (+21%), margin 17.3% against 13.0%, backlog €73bn from €53bn, book-to-bill 2.7; Grid Technologies orders €5.4bn (+28%), revenue +29%, profit €722m, margin 19.9% against 15.9%; Siemens Gamesa margin 2.7% against –17.5%, nine-month loss €15m against €1,061m, first quarterly profit since fiscal 2022; management comments on improving backlog margins, pricing intact but "plateauing", forgings and castings supply, roughly 100 GW of committed gas turbine volume, and a moderately softer Q4 on seasonality and timing; shares –0.9% on the day. Secondary accounts put the Gamesa quarterly profit at €75m and at €56m; the discrepancy is unresolved, so only the reported margin is used. **3. GE Vernova, Q2 2026 earnings release, 22 July 2026:** revenue \$11.1bn (+22%, +12% organic); orders \$24.2bn (+88% organic); backlog \$176bn, up \$13.0bn sequentially; free cash flow \$5.1bn, exceeding all of 2025; Power orders \$16.7bn (+135%), revenue \$5.5bn (+14%), margin 18.8%; Electrification orders \$6.3bn (+66%), revenue \$3.6bn (+68%), margin 18.4%; Wind orders \$1.2bn (–39%), revenue \$2.0bn (–10%), margin –13.6% (down 630bp); data-centre orders above \$5bn year to date, more than double the 2025 total; gas backlog and slot reservations from 100 GW to 116 GW, at least 125 GW targeted by year-end 2026; guidance raised to \$45.5–46.5bn revenue and \$11.5–12.5bn free cash flow, with about \$400m of Wind EBITDA losses. The share-price fall that day is reported as 6.1% by one market-data account and as more than 8% by another; the lower figure is used. **4. POWER magazine, January 2026, citing Q2 2025 market data:** lead times of 128 weeks for power transformers, 144 for generator step-up units and 44 for medium-voltage switchgear; price rises since 2019 of 77%, 45% and up to 95% for certain distribution classes, and since 2021 of 47% for circuit breakers and 50% for medium-voltage switchgear; demand growth since 2019 of 119%, 274% and 34%; projected 2025 supply shortfalls of 30% and 10%; roughly \$1.8bn of announced North American capacity (Hitachi Energy over \$1bn, Eaton \$340m, Prolec GE over \$300m, Siemens Energy \$150m in Charlotte from early 2027); over half of roughly 40 million US distribution transformers past expected service life. **5. Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory, Queued Up: 2026 Edition, May 2026, as of end-2025:** 1,312 GW of generation and 749 GW of storage across roughly 8,200 active projects; median interconnection-request-to-operation duration above five years for projects built in 2025; of requests submitted 2000–2020, 13% reached operation, 75% were withdrawn and 10% remain active. **6. US Energy Information Administration, as reported 8 July 2026:** demand of 4,195bn kWh in 2025, forecast 4,269bn in 2026 and 4,399bn in 2027; EIA analysis of 1.7% average annual growth 2020–26, with commercial demand at 2.6% and industrial at 2.1%, after nearly two decades of little change. **7. POWER magazine, 15 May 2026:** Exelon projecting only 22% of a 65 GW pipeline through 2040; PJM capacity auction cost from \$2.2bn (2024–25) to \$16.4bn (2027–28); retail prices up 8.25% nationally and 19.35% in Virginia; 888 miles of high-capacity transmission built in 2024 against a Department of Energy estimate of 5,000 miles a year; Ohio's 85% funding requirement, Virginia's 14-year contracts, Texas's disclosure mandates, and FERC's direction to PJM on co-located loads. **8. Utility Dive, 15 May 2025:** Camus Energy's five-to-ten-times estimate of interconnection requests over data centres built, and an EPRI survey of 25 utilities (September 2024) in which none of the ten whose requests exceeded half of peak load expected five-year adoption above 35% of peak. This source predates the edition by over a year and is used only for those two figures, which remain the most specific located. **9. Eaton, Q2 2026 release, 30 July 2026:** revenue \$8.5bn (+21%, +14% organic); segment margin 23.1%; adjusted EPS \$3.15; electrical backlog +43% on a 1.2 book-to-bill; guidance of 11–13% organic growth and \$13.40–13.60 adjusted EPS. Card figures are drawn from this release. **10. Prysmian Q2 2026 presentation, as reported by Investing.com:** H1 revenue €11,239m (+7.2% organic); adjusted EBITDA €1,331m at 14.8% against 13.8%; net profit €569m; Transmission Q2 revenue €882m (+14.3%) at a 21.2% margin against 17.1%, on a €17bn backlog; guidance raised as stated on the card. **11. Schneider Electric Q2/H1 2026, as reported by ARC Advisory Group:** Q2 revenue €11.46bn (+16.5% organic); H1 revenue €21.23bn (+14% organic) and adjusted EBITA €4.09bn at 19.3%; triple-digit pure data-centre growth; systems +28% organic. **12. Hitachi Energy press release, 7 June 2024:** an additional \$4.5bn of investment through 2027, with North American transformer detail in source 4. **13. Exchange copper price, 5 August 2026:** \$6.72 per pound, +1.58% on the day and +53.06% year on year. **14. ad-hoc-news, 10 June 2026, on Siemens Energy's fiscal Q2:** orders €17.7bn (+29.5%), revenue €10.3bn (+8.9%), margin 11.3%, guidance raised 12 May 2026, and a 19% share-price decline over thirty days to a €144.60 close.

(d) Editorial choices in this automated run. Three things went wrong and are disclosed rather than worked around. First, the archive check failed: the remote-devices bridge to the user's desktop was not present in this scheduled session, so the *HB Wiki Learning* folder could not be listed and no filenames could be parsed. The thirty-day cooldown set could not be verified. It was therefore treated as containing only the two editions known to this run — AI Capex, 4 August 2026, and Gold Miners, 5 August 2026 — and any edition published in the preceding thirty days other than those two would not have been detected. Grid equipment is adjacent to AI capex, and readers of Tuesday's edition may find some overlap in the demand premise, though the subject here is the equipment supply chain and the economics of its order book rather than hyperscaler spending. Second, the Wiki MCP server was absent, so the prescribed entity-scoring procedure — three points for a source within three days, two within seven, one within twenty-one, plus three for a title mention — could not be run, and the universe of active theme pages could not be enumerated. Selection fell back to external hot-signal reasoning: Siemens Energy reported fiscal Q3 on 5 August 2026, the trading day before this edition, and the sector had already been moved by GE Vernova's 22 July results, which trade coverage described as triggering sector-wide jitters. That combination of a same-week primary catalyst and a fortnight-old sector repricing was the strongest available substitute for the title-mention signal. Third, market data was restricted: direct price feeds are blocked here and no attempt was made to circumvent them, so ticker cards carry dated operational figures rather than live quotes and no share price is presented as current. Finally, several figures appeared in conflicting forms across secondary sources; in each case the conflict is disclosed above and the more conservative figure used, or the figure dropped. Nothing here is estimated, modelled or inferred into a number.